

A NEW DAY OF INFAMY

Hijacked jetliners crash into World Trade Center, Pentagon



AP photo

The Statue of Liberty stands at the entrance to New York Harbor as the twin towers of the World Trade Center burn in the background Tuesday morning.

Thousands die in day of terror

By David Crary
and Jerry Schwartz
The Associated Press

NEW YORK — In the most devastating terrorist onslaught ever waged against the United States, knife-wielding hijackers crashed two airliners into the World Trade Center on Tuesday, toppling its twin 110-story towers. The deadly calamity was witnessed on televisions across the world as another plane slammed into the Pentagon, and a fourth crashed outside Pittsburgh.

"Today, our nation saw evil," President Bush said in an address to the nation Tuesday night. He said thousands of lives were "suddenly ended by evil, despicable acts of terror."

Said Adm. Robert J. Natter, commander of the U.S. Atlantic Fleet: "We have been attacked like we haven't since Pearl Harbor."

Establishing the U.S. death toll could take weeks. The four airliners alone had 266 people aboard and there were no known survivors. At the Pentagon, about 100 people were believed dead.

In addition, a firefighters union

official said he feared half of the 400 firefighters who first reached the scene had died in rescue efforts at the trade center — where 50,000 people worked — and dozens of police officers were believed missing.

"The number of casualties will be more than most of us can bear," a visibly distraught Mayor Rudolph Giuliani said.

"We have entire companies that are just missing," said firefighters union vice president Mike Carter. "We lost chiefs. . . . We're going to have to bury a lot of people."

A police source said some people trapped in the twin towers managed to call authorities or family members, but it was not clear how many people or when all the calls were made. In one of the calls, which took place in the afternoon, a businessman called his family to say he was trapped with police officers, whom he named, the source said.

No one took responsibility for the attacks that rocked the seats of finance and government. But federal authorities identified

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Rumsfeld 'saw' second tragedy

By Robert Burns
The Associated Press

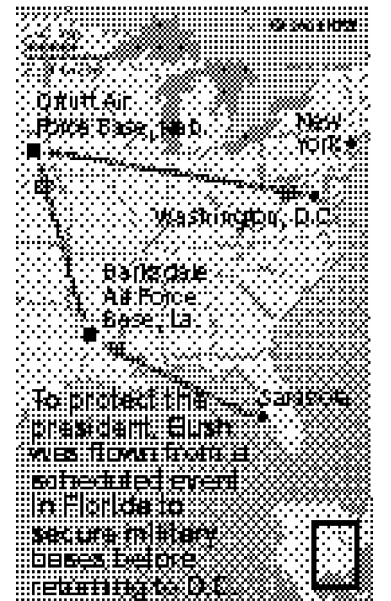
WASHINGTON — Inside the Pentagon, Defense Secretary Donald H. Rumsfeld had just raced to his office after hearing of the World Trade Center attack. On a house porch a little more than a mile away, Ralph Banton, 79, was enjoying a crystal-clear morning.

Then Banton heard a jet flying directly overhead, very low. "It sounded like it was jetting instead of slowing down," he said.

Seconds later, American Flight 77, hijacked while carrying 64 people from Washington to Los Angeles, tore into the side of the Pentagon in a shocking terror attack aimed at the building that represents America's military power around the world.

The Pentagon burst into flames, sending into the blue sky a huge cloud of smoke visible for miles. And a part of the western side of the five-sided building in suburban Arlington, Va., collapsed.

Rumsfeld was in his office when the aircraft hit on the opposite side of the building. He



had just run there after hearing of the Trade Center attack while at a meeting on missile defense in his private dining room.

U.S. Rep. Christopher Cox, R-Calif., also at the meeting, said Rumsfeld had just predicted that the United States would face another terrorist incident at some

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